

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) KO

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.92/4.00)

- Mathematics Minor

Champaign, Illinois
January 2023 - May 2025 (Expected)

WORK EXPERIENCE

STAT107 Data Science Discovery
Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois
August 2023 - Present

- Assist over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive sessions and clarifications
- Manage Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials
- Collaborate with a team of 100+ staff and 2 professors in weekly meetings

STAT443 Professional Statistics
Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois
January 2025 - Present

- Grade assignments and provide feedback to 20+ students on statistical analysis and consulting
- Act as a client in mock projects, simulating real-world consulting challenges

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences
AI/ML Intern Team Leader

Champaign, Illinois
January 2024 - December 2024

- Lead a team of 5 interns
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT
- Collaborated closely with 3 coordinators in weekly meetings to align project goals and track progress

KM Internacional S.A.
Intern

Managua, Nicaragua
May 2023 - August 2023

- Oversaw comprehensive inventory management and streamlined administrative tasks for a small textile company
- Lead a team of three workers to achieve a 98% accuracy rate in record-keeping and a 15% reduction in operational costs

PROJECTS/AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

September 2024 - December 2024

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records.
- Built an interactive Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors, enabling real-time graduation predictions for university administrators.

3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge

September 2024

- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed data-driven interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Paraphrase Detection

July 2024

- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset
- Developed a Gradio interface for real-time paraphrase detection, facilitating easier evaluation of textual similarities for academic and business use cases

SKILLS

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Fluent), Korean (Fluent), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer: Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib, Seaborn, BERT, Random Forest, XGBoost, Gradio
R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret
Git (Intermediate), SAS (Basic), Tableau (Basic), SQL (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates: Data Science DISCOVERY, Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

September 2024 - December 2024

- Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to deliver strategic solutions for real-world business challenges, including market analysis, operational optimization, and growth strategy, for clients ranging from Fortune 100 companies to nonprofits